



**Controlled Start Up**

**Project Mandate  
Template & Notes**

## **Controlled Start Up: Project Mandate**

The Project Mandate is usually the first document produced to trigger a project. The Project Mandate is not seen as project documentation but as a pre-project document. However, often the trigger to a project is poor and it is wise to put together a document, which encapsulates the ideas and any basic information that can be gleaned at this point.

This document should not take more than a day to write and it could take as short a time as one hour. It only needs to contain the information that is readily available. Any detailed documentation can be referenced. The document should also be short and sharp rather than full-blown documentation.

### **Further support**

For further advice and support on Project Management please contact:

[www.PMadvice.co.uk](http://www.PMadvice.co.uk)

## **PROJECT MANDATE**

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## Review

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## Approval

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## Document History

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## **1. PURPOSE**

This document contains the information that is used to trigger the Starting up a Project Process. It will also identify the prospective Project Executive and Project Manager.

## **2. AUTHORITY RESPONSIBLE**

*State the Authority responsible for authorising cost and resource usage.*

## **3. BACKGROUND**

*Explain the context of the Project and what it was that suggested the need for it. State whether the project will be a stand-alone activity to fulfill a particular business requirement or whether it is part of a larger programme.*

## **4. PROJECT OBJECTIVES**

*Explain what the Project is trying to achieve by stating its objectives, which should be measurable and defined in terms of the project's major deliverables, effort, cost, tolerances and business benefits expected.*

## **5. SCOPE**

*Describe the major deliverables of the Project along with specific products, which are not part of the Project. Describe the major dependencies (which impact on the project during its life) and interdependencies, which will exist after implementation.*

## **6. CONSTRAINTS**

*Describe the constraints within which the Project must operate. For example there may be constraints on the amount of resources available to the Project or the location of the Project Team.*

## **7. INTERFACES**

*Describe any interfaces with the Project both internal and external to the organisation including any links to other Projects or Programme(s) of Projects.*

## **8. QUALITY EXPECTATIONS**

*Define the Customer's Quality Expectations with reference to the relative importance of time, cost and quality of the product so that future decisions may be based on what factor is paramount to the project's success.*

## **9. OUTLINE BUSINESS CASE**

*State the business justification for doing the Project.*

## **10. ASSOCIATED DOCUMENTS**

*Make reference to any other earlier work that may include useful information, such as an estimate of the Project's size and duration, a view of the Risks faced by the Project, etc.*

## **11. PROPOSED EXECUTIVE AND PROJECT MANAGER**

*Insert the names of the Proposed Project Executive and Project Manager.*

## **12. CUSTOMERS AND USERS**

*Insert the names of all known users and customers and any other interested parties.*